

Advanced Spine & Joint Care in the Heart of Seoul

A specialised spine and joint hospital in Gangnam known for minimally invasive endoscopic spine surgery, robot-assisted joint replacement and non-surgical pain treatment — from diagnosis to rehabilitation under one roof.

3,000+ joint replacements performed by the head of the Joint Center	**5,000+** arthroscopic procedures in the practice of the head of the Joint Center	**0.5 mm** bone-cutting accuracy of robot-assisted joint replacement (ROSA)	**5** specialised centres: spine, joints, pain, rehabilitation, internal medicine

Endoscopic spine surgery
Minimal incision, local anaesthesia, fast return to daily life

Robotic joint surgery
ROSA-assisted knee replacement planned for each patient

Non-surgical treatment
Image-guided nerve blocks, regenerative injections, shockwave

Rehabilitation
Manual therapy and the Sky Walking gait-training system

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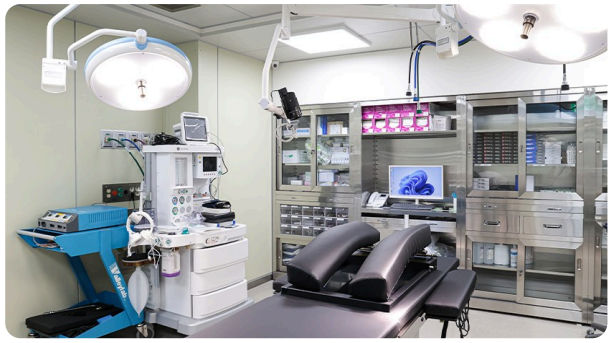
SEOUL MEDICAL CENTER
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WHO WE ARE

01 About the Clinic

Cheongdam Harrison Hospital is a specialised spine and joint hospital in Gangnam, Seoul. It was founded to bring Korea's world-recognised expertise in spinal treatment — above all endoscopic spine surgery — to more patients, and to provide more advanced and effective care built on years of research.

Korean spine care is recognised internationally, and every year doctors from many countries come to Korea to learn endoscopic spine surgery. Harrison surgeons have developed a new endoscopic treatment for spinal stenosis, established the world's first two-handed biportal endoscopic spine surgery technique, and train visiting foreign surgeons through the H-STEP programme.



Harrison Safe Surgery Center — operating theatre (4F)

MISSION

A patient-centred hospital that goes further to create an innovative world of care

VISION

Compassion	Independence	Creativity	Practicality
love for people	own technology	new methods	the right treatment

CORE VALUES

- Respect for life and for every patient
- Open communication with patients and their families
- Empathy for the patient's discomfort
- Mutual trust between patient and hospital
- Passion for continuous research and new challenges

The spine

The pillar of the body: every segment is linked to vital organs. Restoring it restores quality of life.

Leadership

Taking Korean spine expertise to the world as a recognised medical legacy.

Research

Constant work on safer techniques with fewer side effects and faster recovery.

Sharing

Medical volunteering, training of new specialists and the 2026 Medical Sharing Project for Koryo-saram patients from Uzbekistan.

Hospital building — floor guide

B2	Sky Walking rehabilitation centre
B1	MRI, CT, X-ray, bone densitometry, thermography, EEG
2F	Consultation rooms 1, 2, 7 · Reception · Spine surgery consultation
3F	Consultation rooms 3–6 · Pain treatment · Joint surgery consultation
4F	Harrison Safe Surgery Center (operating theatres)
5–7F	Inpatient wards (rooms 501–504, 601–604, 701–704)
8F	VIP rooms 1–4 · Sky lounge
9F	Conference room · Sky garden
+	Exercise therapy, manual therapy and physiotherapy rooms

Diagnostic & treatment equipment

MRI 1.5T	HDxt	CT, 16-slice	LightSpeed 16
C-arm fluoroscopy	KMC-650P	Digital X-ray	GXR-52S
Ultrasound	RS80 · P5	Bone densitometry	DexxumT
Thermography (DITI)	IRIS-8000	Brain/body wave test	UNO-Check
Pain & sensory test	PS-3100	Focused shockwave	PiezoClast
Shockwave + magnetic	Optimus Pro	Surgical robot	ROSA



VIP room (8F)



Sky Walking rehab (B2)



Imaging (B1)

World first

Two-handed biportal endoscopic spine surgery technique established by Dr. Dong-Hwa Heo

JNS Spine

Clinic research selected as the cover article of the July issue of the international spine journal

H-STEP

Training programme for foreign surgeons in endoscopic spine surgery

Uzbekistan 2026

Medical Sharing Project: treatment of Koryo-saram patients together with Gangnam District

DEPARTMENTS & SPECIALISTS

02 Departments and Doctors

Spine Center
Lumbar & cervical disc herniation, spinal stenosis, spondylolisthesis, OPLL, compression fractures, straight-neck syndrome

Joint Center
Robotic Surgery Center · knee, shoulder & hip · Fracture Clinic · Sports Injury & Regenerative Clinic

Pain Treatment Center
Ultrasound- and X-ray-guided nerve blocks, prolotherapy, shockwave, hydrodissection

Manual Therapy & Rehabilitation
1:1 manual therapy by physiotherapists, Sky Walking gait training, post-operative rehab

Internal Medicine Center
Cardiovascular, GI, respiratory & endocrine disorders, check-ups, vaccinations, weight management

Radiology
Musculoskeletal MRI & CT reading, ultrasound diagnostics



NEUROSURGERY

Dr. Hyeun-Sung Kim
Hospital Director · Spine Center

Complex spine surgery, endoscopic spine surgery

- Former Director, Spine Center, Gangnam Nanoori Hospital
- Past President, Korean Research Society of Endoscopic Spine Surgery
- Executive Board Member, Korean Minimally Invasive Spine Society



NEUROSURGERY

Dr. Dong-Hwa Heo
CEO & Representative Director · Spine Center

Complex spine surgery, endoscopic spine surgery

- Former Head, Spine Endoscopy Center, Seoul Bumin Hospital
- Former Director, Spine Endoscopy Center, Champodonamu Hospital
- Vice President, Korean Research Society of Biportal Endoscopic Spine Surgery



NEUROSURGERY

Dr. Sung-Hoon Oh
Honorary Director · Spine Center

Endoscopic spine surgery

- Former President, Korean Research Society of Minimally Invasive Spine Surgery (KONISS)
- Former Director, Incheon Nanoori Hospital
- Former President, Korean Society of Spinal Arthroplasty



NEUROSURGERY

Dr. Dong-Wook Kim
Head of Department · Spine Center

Endoscopic spine surgery, disc herniation, spinal stenosis

- Board-certified neurosurgeon
- Graduate of Eulji University College of Medicine
- Internship at Eulji University Hospital, Daejeon



ORTHOPAEDIC SURGERY

Dr. Seung-Yeol Ryu
Hospital Director · Joint Center

Knee & shoulder, arthroscopy, osteotomy, joint replacement, fractures, sports injuries

- Former Clinical Professor, Knee Division, Seoul National University Hospital
- Former Medical Director, Joint Center, Mokdong Himchan Hospital
- 3,000+ joint replacements · 5,000+ arthroscopies



ANAESTHESIOLOGY & PAIN MEDICINE

Dr. Ji-Hwan Lee
Director · Pain Treatment Center

Non-surgical treatment, nerve blocks; general, epidural, spinal & regional anaesthesia

- Former Director, Gangnam Nanoori Hospital
- Former Director, Suwon Wiltse Memorial Hospital
- Trained at Samsung Medical Center



FAMILY MEDICINE

Dr. I-Rang Song
Director · Internal Medicine Center

Chronic adult diseases, vaccinations, menopause care, weight management, chronic fatigue

- Personalised check-ups based on medical and family history
- Early detection of internal disorders



RADIOLOGY

Dr. Yeon-Ju Lee
Director · Radiology

Musculoskeletal imaging (CT, MRI), ultrasound diagnostics

- MRI / CT reading for spine and joint patients
- Diagnostic ultrasound

SIGNATURE TECHNOLOGIES

03 Treatment Methods

Precise diagnosis first — then the least invasive effective treatment

Every plan is made after a detailed examination, imaging and, when needed, a joint consultation of specialists from several centres.

A Endoscopic spine surgery

Treats lumbar and cervical disc herniation and spinal stenosis through a minimal incision. Healthy muscles and ligaments are largely preserved; the procedure is performed under local anaesthesia while the surgeon sees the lesion directly through the endoscope with real-time imaging. Discectomy, nerve decompression and spinal fusion can all be performed endoscopically.

Advantages

- Minimal incision — less muscle damage and scarring
- Possible for patients with heart disease, kidney disease or diabetes
- Suitable for elderly patients — no general-anaesthesia concerns
- Fast recovery and early return to daily life
- Precise: only the thickened ligament or herniated disc is removed

	Biportal (UBE)	Uniportal
Access	Two small incisions — one for the endoscope, one for instruments	A single incision
Strength	Wide treatment range, highly precise work	Smallest area of muscle and bone damage
Closure	Medical glue, no stitches — minimal scar	Medical glue, no stitches — minimal scar

Indicated for: disc herniation and stenosis; recurrence after surgery or non-surgical treatment; no improvement with conservative care; elderly or chronically ill patients unfit for conventional surgery.

01 Lesion located with a C-arm image intensifier

02 Minimal incision and insertion of the endoscope

03 Surgery under direct endoscopic view

04 Incision closed with medical glue — no stitches

B Robot-assisted joint replacement (ROSA)

The robot does not replace the surgeon: it carries out the surgeon's plan with greater precision. Each operation is planned individually according to the joint condition, deformity and alignment — based on experience from more than 3,000 joint replacements.

- Complication rate minimised since the robot was introduced
- Patients in their 70s and 80s can start gait training early
- Experience: 3,000+ knee and hip replacements

01 Precise planning of resection and implant position

02 Robot-assisted bone cutting

03 Implant insertion, check of ligament balance and alignment

04 Gait training and staged rehabilitation

Parameter	Conventional	Robot-assisted
Bone cutting	Depends on surgeon's skill	**Accuracy within 0.5 mm**
Ligament balance	Checked manually	**Real-time sensor feedback**
Bleeding, tissue damage	Relatively higher	**Minimised**
Recovery	Relatively long	**Early walking**
Implant lifespan	Standard	**Longer, due to precise alignment**
Incision	Standard size	**Smaller**

C Regenerative therapy

For patients who wish to avoid or postpone surgery: arthritis, partial rotator cuff tears, chronic ligament and tendon injuries.

PRP · BMAC stem cells · Collagen / hyaluronic acid · Prolotherapy · Shockwave (ESWT)

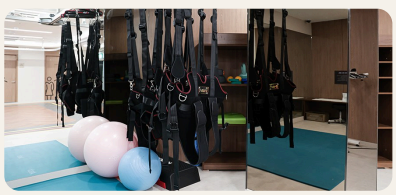
D Image-guided pain treatment

The source of pain is targeted precisely under ultrasound or X-ray; most patients return to normal activities the same day.

Ultrasound-guided nerve block · X-ray-guided nerve block · Prolotherapy · Shockwave · Hydrodissection

E Manual therapy & Sky Walking

Physiotherapists provide 1:1 manual therapy (joint and spinal correction, myofascial release). The Sky Walking body-weight-support system helps patients with weak legs, poor balance or pain walk again.



WHAT WE TREAT

04 Main Surgical and Non-Surgical Procedures

Treatment always starts with the least invasive option. Surgery is recommended when conservative treatment does not help, or when muscle weakness, numbness or other neurological symptoms appear.

Area	Main conditions	Non-surgical treatment	Surgical treatment
Spine Neurosurgery	– Lumbar disc herniation – Cervical disc herniation – Spinal stenosis – Spondylolisthesis – Ossification of the posterior longitudinal ligament (OPLL) – Osteoporotic compression fracture – Straight-neck syndrome	– Medication and physiotherapy – Nerve block injections – Percutaneous epidural neuroplasty (catheter adhesiolysis) – Manual therapy	– Endoscopic discectomy (uniportal / biportal) – Endoscopic foraminotomy and decompression – Endoscopic or microscopic interbody fusion – Microscopic cervical artificial disc replacement
Knee Orthopaedics	– Osteoarthritis – Meniscus tear – ACL / PCL rupture – Cartilage damage – Bow-leg / knock-knee deformity – Bursitis, tendinitis, chondromalacia patellae	– PRP injections – BMAC stem-cell therapy – Shockwave therapy (ESWT) – Intra-articular injections (cartilage, collagen, prolotherapy)	– Arthroscopy: meniscus repair / resection, cartilage regeneration – Corrective osteotomy – Stem-cell cartilage regeneration (Cartistem, MegaCarti) – Partial knee replacement (UKR) – Robotic total knee replacement (ROSA)
Shoulder Orthopaedics	– Rotator cuff tear – Frozen shoulder – Impingement, calcific tendinitis – Dislocation / instability, SLAP lesion – AC joint injury	– Shockwave (calcific tendinitis) – PRP / collagen injections – Manual therapy and rehabilitation	– Arthroscopy: rotator cuff repair, labrum repair – Arthroscopic treatment of severe frozen shoulder, AC joint arthritis – Shoulder joint replacement
Hip Orthopaedics	– Hip dysplasia – Avascular necrosis of the femoral head – Hip osteoarthritis	– Medication, physiotherapy, injections	– Total hip replacement with staged rehabilitation
Fractures Fracture Clinic	– Stress fractures – Shoulder, wrist, hip and ankle fractures – Spinal fractures	– Cast / brace immobilisation – Osteoporosis treatment and prevention (DEXA)	– Intramedullary nailing – Plate and screw fixation – Joint replacement for hip fractures in the elderly – Early rehabilitation programme for elderly patients
Sports injuries Sports & Regenerative Clinic	– Muscle tears and contusions – Ankle ligament injury, recurrent sprain – Plantar fasciitis – Achilles tendon rupture / tendinitis – Knee ligament injury – Tennis / golfer's elbow	– Shockwave (ESWT) – Ultrasound-guided injections – PRP injections – Sports rehabilitation programme	– Arthroscopic ligament reconstruction / repair
Pain & neuralgia Pain Center	– Chronic neck and back pain – Nerve, joint and muscle pain – Disc-related pain, neuropathy – Post-herpetic neuralgia	– Ultrasound- / X-ray-guided nerve blocks – Prolotherapy, shockwave, hydrodissection – Manual therapy, CPM, cryotherapy	– Non-surgical centre — if surgery is needed, it is performed by the Spine or Joint Center

Diagnostics
MRI, CT, X-ray, ultrasound, DITI thermography, bone densitometry, blood tests, ECG

Osteoporosis clinic
Painless 10-minute DEXA scan, T-score diagnosis, medication and follow-up to prevent repeat fractures

Internal medicine
Hypertension, diabetes, lipids, thyroid, liver, GI and lungs; ECG, echocardiography, abdominal & thyroid ultrasound, tumour markers

Wellness
Vaccinations, IV therapy, nutrition tests, weight-management and chronic-fatigue programmes



Harrison Safe Surgery Center (4F)


Inpatient ward (7F)


Consultation room (2F)

YOUR CONTACT IN KAZAKHSTAN

05 Contacts

For consultations and treatment at Cheongdam Harrison Hospital, please contact Seoul Medical Center in Almaty.

SEOUL MEDICAL CENTER

DIAGNOSTIC CENTRE · ALMATY

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Diagnostics in Almaty before your trip

MRI	CT	Ultrasound	Digital X-ray	Lab tests	Full check-up
from 15,000 ₸	from 18,500 ₸	from 6,000 ₸	from 5,000 ₸	from 1,100 ₸	from 95,000 ₸

SG Healthcare equipment
Imaging systems from the Korean manufacturer SG Healthcare

Same-day results
Results on the day of the examination; report within 24 hours

Korean standards
Reports prepared to Korean medical standards, with telemedicine option

AI in diagnostics
Artificial intelligence shortens scan time and improves image accuracy

How the examination works

01 Request
Via the website, phone or WhatsApp — we select the examination and a convenient time

02 No queues
Patients are seen strictly by appointment

03 Examination
Fast and comfortable scanning; AI shortens the procedure

04 Result
On the day of the visit; the report is ready within 24 hours


Waiting area

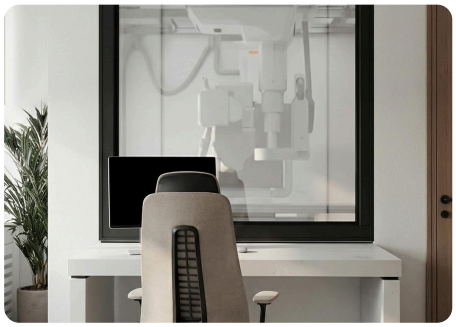

Doctor's office


Image review

Clinic information: harrisonhospital.co.kr; contact details and prices: seoulmed.kz (October 2026); prices are indicative, please confirm when booking. The treatment method is determined individually after examination.